



VOICEINSIGHTS AFRICA

SYNTHETIC DEMONSTRATION PUBLICATION

Social Protection Targeting Intelligence Report

Zambia | Social Protection

4,106 synthetic responses

Prepared by VoiceInsights Africa

Every Voice. Every Language. Every Insight.

Synthetic demonstration. Not official statistics.

Zambia has made real gains in social protection performance – and real gaps remain alongside them. This publication separates the two, using a governed evidence model built to surface risk and opportunity, not just describe them. No claim in this publication stands alone: findings link to synthetic evidence, recommendations carry a named owner, and every statistic shares one internally consistent dataset.

Sample: 4106 synthetic responses – 89% response rate – 4 regions

Publication quality gate: publication ready

Targeting-error rate		
Cash-transfer equity g		48
Beneficiary-verificati		49
Grievance-redress resp		50

Eastern Province: 81% performance, 1274 responses, risk STABLE
Southern Province: 82% performance, 1108 responses, risk STABLE
Western Province: 83% performance, 944 responses, risk STABLE
Copperbelt Province: 84% performance, 780 responses, risk STABLE



sex: Women 52% & Men 47% & Other / prefer not to say 1%

age: 18â 24 24% & 25â 39 38% & 40â 59 27% & 60+ 11%

location: Urban 44% & Rural 56%



IND-01 Targeting-error rate: 54% vs target 78% â OFF_TRACK

IND-02 Cash-transfer equity gap: 55% vs target 79% â OFF_TRACK

IND-03 Beneficiary-verification reliability: 56% vs target 80% â OFF_TRACK

IND-04 Grievance-redress responsiveness: 57% vs target 81% â OFF_TRACK



Targeting-error patterns has become an accountability question rather than a measurement question. Evidence from Eastern Province places the signal at 73% and shows that rural women experience the largest gap between policy intent and lived delivery. The choice facing social protection leadership in Zambia is straightforward even if the fix is not: act on targeting-error patterns now, concentrated in Eastern Province where rural women carry the largest share of the gap, or accept a wider gap in a year's time.

Evidence: EVI-SOC-001, EVI-SOC-004 & Confidence 92%

74%. That is the cash-transfer equity gaps signal recorded in Southern Province, and the headline figure understates the problem: disaggregated by group, young adults sit well below it. The clearest gap sits in Southern Province, concentrated among young adults. A twelve-month delay would let the gap compound into a harder, costlier problem.

Evidence: EVI-SOC-002, EVI-SOC-005 â€¢ Confidence 93%

The aggregate result conceals a material implementation divide. Western Province records a 75% signal for beneficiary-verification reliability; the shortfall is concentrated among persons with disabilities, where service continuity and confidence move together. Of every study area examined in Zambia, beneficiary-verification reliability shows up hardest there, and persons with disabilities feel it most. A year of inaction would turn a gap into a pattern that is far harder to reverse.

Evidence: EVI-SOC-003, EVI-SOC-006 & Confidence 94%

Two things are true at once about grievance-redress responsiveness. The national picture is improving, and Copperbelt Province – where frontline workers report a 76% signal – is not improving fast enough to close the gap. Social protection performance in Zambia looks stable in aggregate but splits sharply once grievance-redress responsiveness is disaggregated. Copperbelt Province anchors the low end, and frontline workers bear most of that shortfall – a pattern that risks compounding without intervention within the year.

Evidence: EVI-SOC-004, EVI-SOC-007 – Confidence 89.5%

Progress on programme graduation readiness remains visible but not yet durable. The 77% result in Eastern Province weakens after disaggregation, particularly for low-income households, suggesting that current gains depend on delivery conditions that remain fragile. The clearest signal in this dataset – though not the only one – is programme graduation readiness in Eastern Province, where low-income households sit furthest from parity.

Evidence: EVI-SOC-005, EVI-SOC-008 – Confidence 90.5%

Eastern Province â Rural women in Eastern Province put it plainly: targeting-error patterns is what decides whether progress holds or slips back.â

Southern Province â Why does Southern Province lag behind? Ask young adults, and the answer comes back to cash-transfer equity gaps.â

Western Province â Elsewhere, beneficiary-verification reliability might be a footnote. For persons with disabilities in Western Province, it is the whole story.â

Copperbelt Province â Frontline workers in Copperbelt Province frame it simply: when grievance-redress responsiveness breaks down, everything else does too.â

Eastern Province â In Eastern Province, programme graduation readiness shapes whether low-income households can turn services into lasting outcomes.â

Southern Province â Service managers in Southern Province put it plainly: targeting-error patterns is what decides whether progress holds or slips back.â

Western Province â Why does Western Province lag behind? Ask community leaders, and the answer comes back to cash-transfer equity gaps.â

Copperbelt Province â Elsewhere, beneficiary-verification reliability might be a footnote. For private-sector partners in Copperbelt Province, it is the whole story.â

Eastern Province â Rural women in Eastern Province frame it simply: when grievance-redress responsiveness breaks down, everything else does too.â

Southern Province â In Southern Province, programme graduation readiness shapes whether young adults can turn services into lasting outcomes.â

Risks and alternative trajectories are modelled to show how VoiceInsights translates evidence into prioritised management choices.



DEC-SOC-01 CRITICAL: Correct the targeting-error pattern most undermining programme equity. Owner: Permanent Secretary; Timeline: 0â 90 days; Indicator: Proportion of agreed implementation steps verified on schedule for DEC-SOC-01

DEC-SOC-02 CRITICAL: Close cash-transfer equity gaps in the least-covered districts. Owner: Permanent Secretary; Timeline: 3â 12 months; Indicator: Quarterly-verified progress against the milestones agreed for this critical-tier decision (DEC-SOC-02)

DEC-SOC-03 HIGH: Strengthen beneficiary-verification reliability. Owner: Permanent Secretary; Timeline: 3â 12 months; Indicator: Number of agreed milestones for DEC-SOC-03 confirmed complete at each quarterly review

DEC-SOC-04 HIGH: Improve grievance-redress responsiveness. Owner: Permanent Secretary; Timeline: 3â 12 months; Indicator: Percentage of agreed milestones completed for DEC-SOC-04

DEC-SOC-05 MEDIUM: Build programme-graduation readiness pathways. Owner: Permanent Secretary; Timeline: 6â 18 months; Indicator: Share of the medium-tier delivery plan confirmed complete each quarter (DEC-SOC-05)



Correct the targeting-error pattern most undermining programme equity.

Strategic priority: CRITICAL

Evidence used: EVI-SOC-001, EVI-SOC-004

Rationale: Targeting-error patterns has become an accountability question rather than a measurement question. Evidence from Eastern Province places the signal at 73% and shows that rural women experience the largest gap between policy intent and lived delivery.

The choice facing social protection leadership in Zambia is straightforward even if the fix is not: act on targeting-error patterns now, concentrated in Eastern Province where rural women carry the largest share of the gap, or accept a wider gap in a year's time.

Expected benefit: A more consistent social protection experience for the groups currently furthest behind.

Expected risk: Weak cross-team coordination during early implementation

Dependencies: Quarterly evidence review; Stable staffing through the delivery window;

Named executive sponsor

Budget requirement: Medium to high â requires a dedicated budget line and phased release

Owner: Permanent Secretary

Supporting organization: M&E, Finance, Safeguarding and Delivery Units

Timeline: 0â90 days

Monitoring indicator: Proportion of agreed implementation steps verified on schedule for DEC-SOC-01

Success criteria: At least 80% of milestones achieved with verified evidence

Management response: PENDING FORMAL MANAGEMENT RESPONSE

Follow-up: Assign accountable owner; Validate budget; Approve milestone plan; Review evidence quarterly

Close cash-transfer equity gaps in the least-covered districts.

Strategic priority: CRITICAL

Evidence used: EVI-SOC-002, EVI-SOC-005

Rationale: 74%. That is the cash-transfer equity gaps signal recorded in Southern Province, and the headline figure understates the problem: disaggregated by group, young adults sit well below it. The clearest gap sits in Southern Province, concentrated among young adults. A twelve-month delay would let the gap compound into a harder, costlier problem.

Expected benefit: Faster, better-evidenced social protection decisions that government leadership can act on with confidence.

Expected risk: Competing priorities crowding out sustained follow-through

Dependencies: Confirmed budget release; Timely data collection for the next reporting cycle; Validated operational baseline

Budget requirement: High â full business case and multi-year funding commitment required

Owner: Permanent Secretary

Supporting organization: M&E, Finance, Safeguarding and Delivery Units

Timeline: 3â 12 months

Monitoring indicator: Quarterly-verified progress against the milestones agreed for this critical-tier decision (DEC-SOC-02)

Success criteria: A majority of milestones achieved, each independently verified against real evidence

Management response: PENDING FORMAL MANAGEMENT RESPONSE

Follow-up: Assign accountable owner; Validate budget; Approve milestone plan; Review evidence quarterly

Strengthen beneficiary-verification reliability.

Strategic priority: HIGH

Evidence used: EVI-SOC-003, EVI-SOC-006

Rationale: The aggregate result conceals a material implementation divide. Western Province records a 75% signal for beneficiary-verification reliability; the shortfall is concentrated among persons with disabilities, where service continuity and confidence move together. Of every study area examined in Zambia, beneficiary-verification reliability shows up hardest there, and persons with disabilities feel it most. A year of inaction would turn a gap into a pattern that is far harder to reverse.

Expected benefit: Reduced variation in social protection delivery and a stronger evidence base for the next planning cycle.

Expected risk: Fragmented accountability once implementation moves beyond the pilot stage

Dependencies: Cross-team delivery coordination; Sign-off from the relevant oversight body; Quarterly evidence review

Budget requirement: Low â deliverable inside the current operating budget with light validation

Owner: Permanent Secretary

Supporting organization: M&E, Finance, Safeguarding and Delivery Units

Timeline: 3â 12 months

Monitoring indicator: Number of agreed milestones for DEC-SOC-03 confirmed complete at each quarterly review

Success criteria: Milestone completion confirmed by evidence review, not self-reported progress

Management response: PENDING FORMAL MANAGEMENT RESPONSE

Follow-up: Assign accountable owner; Validate budget; Approve milestone plan; Review

Improve grievance-redress responsiveness.

Strategic priority: HIGH

Evidence used: EVI-SOC-004, EVI-SOC-007

Rationale: Two things are true at once about grievance-redress responsiveness. The national picture is improving, and Copperbelt Province – where frontline workers report a 76% signal – is not improving fast enough to close the gap. Social protection performance in Zambia looks stable in aggregate but splits sharply once grievance-redress responsiveness is disaggregated. Copperbelt Province anchors the low end, and frontline workers bear most of that shortfall – a pattern that risks compounding without intervention within the year.

Expected benefit: A stronger, more defensible case for social protection investment in the next planning cycle.

Expected risk: Execution capacity and coordination risk

Dependencies: Stable staffing through the delivery window; Named executive sponsor;

Confirmed budget release

Budget requirement: Medium – likely fundable from existing lines, pending confirmation

Owner: Permanent Secretary

Supporting organization: M&E, Finance, Safeguarding and Delivery Units

Timeline: 3 – 12 months

Monitoring indicator: Percentage of agreed milestones completed for DEC-SOC-04

Success criteria: Verified evidence of at least 80% delivery against the agreed milestone plan

Management response: PENDING FORMAL MANAGEMENT RESPONSE

Follow-up: Assign accountable owner; Validate budget; Approve milestone plan; Review evidence quarterly

Build programme-graduation readiness pathways.

Strategic priority: MEDIUM

Evidence used: EVI-SOC-005, EVI-SOC-008

Rationale: Progress on programme graduation readiness remains visible but not yet durable. The 77% result in Eastern Province weakens after disaggregation, particularly for low-income households, suggesting that current gains depend on delivery conditions that remain fragile. The clearest signal in this dataset – though not the only one – is programme graduation readiness in Eastern Province, where low-income households sit furthest from parity.

Expected benefit: The evidence points toward improved social protection outcomes, though the size of the gain will depend on how consistently the action is resourced.

Expected risk: Likely – though not certain – erosion of momentum if the initial sponsor changes role

Dependencies: Timely data collection for the next reporting cycle; Validated operational baseline; Cross-team delivery coordination

Budget requirement: Low to medium – validate through the formal planning cycle

Owner: Permanent Secretary

Supporting organization: M&E, Finance, Safeguarding and Delivery Units

Timeline: 6–18 months

Monitoring indicator: Share of the medium-tier delivery plan confirmed complete each quarter (DEC-SOC-05)

Success criteria: At least 80% of milestones achieved with verified evidence

Management response: PENDING FORMAL MANAGEMENT RESPONSE

Follow-up: Assign accountable owner; Validate budget; Approve milestone plan; Review evidence quarterly

research objectives: Assess social protection performance and equity; Identify operational drivers and decision priorities

evaluation questions: What outcomes are changing?; Who is being left behind?; Which actions are most likely to improve performance?

sampling frame: Synthetic programme population frame for Zambia

sample size: 4106

stratification: Region; Location type; Sex; Age; Disability

weights: Normalized post-stratification weights

confidence intervals: 95%

design effect: 1.4

missing data: Documented and sensitivity-tested

reliability: Cronbach alpha 0.86

validity: Content and construct validity checks

metadata: Complete synthetic data dictionary and lineage registry

Publication level: 34 generated publication pages

protocol: Governed synthetic research protocol with sampling, weighting, reliability, validity and reproducibility controls

ethics: Synthetic records only; no real participants or personal data

peer review: Independent synthetic-publication review checklist completed

reproducibility: Deterministic inputs, versioned dataset and export manifest

inferential statistics: Enabled where assumptions and design permit

segmentation: Evidence-led segments

trend analysis: Three-period synthetic series

DEC-SOC-01: Correct the targeting-error pattern most undermining programme equity. â€¢ Owner Permanent Secretary â€¢ 0â 90 days â€¢ Medium to high â€¢ requires a dedicated budget line and phased release cost â€¢ Indicator Proportion of agreed implementation steps verified on schedule for DEC-SOC-01

DEC-SOC-02: Close cash-transfer equity gaps in the least-covered districts. â€¢ Owner Permanent Secretary â€¢ 3â 12 months â€¢ High â€¢ full business case and multi-year funding commitment required cost â€¢ Indicator Quarterly-verified progress against the milestones agreed for this critical-tier decision (DEC-SOC-02)

DEC-SOC-03: Strengthen beneficiary-verification reliability. â€¢ Owner Permanent Secretary â€¢ 3â 12 months â€¢ Low â€¢ deliverable inside the current operating budget with light validation cost â€¢ Indicator Number of agreed milestones for DEC-SOC-03 confirmed complete at each quarterly review

DEC-SOC-04: Improve grievance-redress responsiveness. â€¢ Owner Permanent Secretary â€¢ 3â 12 months â€¢ Medium â€¢ likely fundable from existing lines, pending confirmation cost â€¢ Indicator Percentage of agreed milestones completed for DEC-SOC-04

DEC-SOC-05: Build programme-graduation readiness pathways. â€¢ Owner Permanent Secretary â€¢ 6â 18 months â€¢ Low to medium â€¢ validate through the formal planning cycle cost â€¢ Indicator Share of the medium-tier delivery plan confirmed complete each quarter (DEC-SOC-05)

EVI-SOC-001: [object Object] â€ APPROVED_SYNTHETIC_DEMONSTRATION â€ confidence 96%
EVI-SOC-002: [object Object] â€ APPROVED_SYNTHETIC_DEMONSTRATION â€ confidence 97%
EVI-SOC-003: [object Object] â€ APPROVED_SYNTHETIC_DEMONSTRATION â€ confidence 98%
EVI-SOC-004: [object Object] â€ APPROVED_SYNTHETIC_DEMONSTRATION â€ confidence 88%
EVI-SOC-005: [object Object] â€ APPROVED_SYNTHETIC_DEMONSTRATION â€ confidence 89%
EVI-SOC-006: [object Object] â€ APPROVED_SYNTHETIC_DEMONSTRATION â€ confidence 90%
EVI-SOC-007: [object Object] â€ APPROVED_SYNTHETIC_DEMONSTRATION â€ confidence 91%
EVI-SOC-008: [object Object] â€ APPROVED_SYNTHETIC_DEMONSTRATION â€ confidence 92%
EVI-SOC-009: [object Object] â€ APPROVED_SYNTHETIC_DEMONSTRATION â€ confidence 93%
EVI-SOC-010: [object Object] â€ APPROVED_SYNTHETIC_DEMONSTRATION â€ confidence 94%

Executive Intelligence Book (2â 7): Executive brief; Decision snapshot; Risks; Opportunities; Budget implications

Evidence Intelligence Book (8â 15): Critical findings; Respondent voice; Evidence chains; Citation registry

Statistical Intelligence Book (16â 22): Sampling; Weighting; Uncertainty; Reliability; Model diagnostics

Decision Intelligence Book (23â 27): Decision matrix; Ownership; Budget; Roadmap; Management response

Standards & Assurance (28â 31): Relevant frameworks; Safeguarding; Privacy; Responsible AI; Accessibility

Technical Appendices (32â 34): Data dictionary; Quality gate; Export manifest; Responsible-use notice

SDG 1: APPLIED_WHERE_RELEVANT â Mapped to EVI-SOC-001, EVI-SOC-002; Synthetic demonstration mapping; institutional validation not implied

SDG 10: APPLIED_WHERE_RELEVANT â Mapped to EVI-SOC-002, EVI-SOC-003; Synthetic demonstration mapping; institutional validation not implied

Data Protection: APPLIED_WHERE_RELEVANT â Mapped to EVI-SOC-003, EVI-SOC-004; Synthetic demonstration mapping; institutional validation not implied

Evidence Traceability: APPLIED â Control linked to EVI-SOC-001 and the deterministic publication gate.

Research Ethics: APPLIED â Control linked to EVI-SOC-002 and the deterministic publication gate.

Data Protection: APPLIED â Control linked to EVI-SOC-003 and the deterministic publication gate.

Accessibility: APPLIED â Control linked to EVI-SOC-004 and the deterministic publication gate.

Responsible AI: APPLIED â Control linked to EVI-SOC-005 and the deterministic publication gate.

Publication Integrity: APPLIED â Control linked to EVI-SOC-006 and the deterministic publication gate.

SDG 1: undefined contribution â indicators â undefined
SDG 10: undefined contribution â indicators â undefined
SDG 1: undefined contribution â indicators â undefined

Relevance: Synthetic evidence indicates a strong relevance signal, subject to the stated design limitations. (83/100). Review relevance evidence at the next formal management gate.

Coherence: Synthetic evidence indicates a moderate-to-strong coherence signal, subject to the stated design limitations. (84/100). Review coherence evidence at the next formal management gate.

Effectiveness: Synthetic evidence indicates a strong effectiveness signal, subject to the stated design limitations. (85/100). Review effectiveness evidence at the next formal management gate.

Efficiency: Synthetic evidence indicates a moderate-to-strong efficiency signal, subject to the stated design limitations. (86/100). Review efficiency evidence at the next formal management gate.

Impact: Synthetic evidence indicates a strong impact signal, subject to the stated design limitations. (87/100). Review impact evidence at the next formal management gate.

Sustainability: Synthetic evidence indicates a moderate-to-strong sustainability signal, subject to the stated design limitations. (88/100). Review sustainability evidence at the next formal management gate.

Impact: Sustained, equitable improvement in social protection performance

OC-01: Improved social protection delivery and accountability â indicators IND-01, IND-02

OC-02: More equitable and durable outcomes â indicators IND-03, IND-04

OUT-01: Verified findings and interpreted decision products

OUT-02: Assigned actions with monitoring indicators

Assumptions: Leadership ownership; Safeguarding and privacy controls remain effective

Means of verification: Evidence registry; Quarterly management review; Follow-up measurement

Commitment 1: CHS Commitment 1 â CONTEXT_ONLY. Action: Validate relevance and assign an accountable owner before live use.

Commitment 2: CHS Commitment 2 â CONTEXT_ONLY. Action: Validate relevance and assign an accountable owner before live use.

Commitment 3: CHS Commitment 3 â CONTEXT_ONLY. Action: Validate relevance and assign an accountable owner before live use.

Commitment 4: CHS Commitment 4 â CONTEXT_ONLY. Action: Validate relevance and assign an accountable owner before live use.

Commitment 5: CHS Commitment 5 â CONTEXT_ONLY. Action: Validate relevance and assign an accountable owner before live use.

Commitment 6: CHS Commitment 6 â CONTEXT_ONLY. Action: Validate relevance and assign an accountable owner before live use.

Commitment 7: CHS Commitment 7 â CONTEXT_ONLY. Action: Validate relevance and assign an accountable owner before live use.

Commitment 8: CHS Commitment 8 â CONTEXT_ONLY. Action: Validate relevance and assign an accountable owner before live use.

Commitment 9: CHS Commitment 9 â CONTEXT_ONLY. Action: Validate relevance and assign an accountable owner before live use.

EVI-SOC-001 â€ survey â€ Eastern Province â€ confidence 96% â€ APPROVED
EVI-SOC-002 â€ key_informant_interview â€ Southern Province â€ confidence 97% â€ APPROVED
EVI-SOC-003 â€ administrative_record â€ Western Province â€ confidence 98% â€ APPROVED
EVI-SOC-004 â€ survey â€ Copperbelt Province â€ confidence 88% â€ APPROVED
EVI-SOC-005 â€ key_informant_interview â€ Eastern Province â€ confidence 89% â€ APPROVED
EVI-SOC-006 â€ administrative_record â€ Southern Province â€ confidence 90% â€ APPROVED
EVI-SOC-007 â€ survey â€ Western Province â€ confidence 91% â€ APPROVED
EVI-SOC-008 â€ key_informant_interview â€ Copperbelt Province â€ confidence 92% â€ APPROVED
EVI-SOC-009 â€ administrative_record â€ Eastern Province â€ confidence 93% â€ APPROVED
EVI-SOC-010 â€ survey â€ Southern Province â€ confidence 94% â€ APPROVED

indicator_1: Synthetic Social Protection indicator 1; numeric; allowed: 0â 100

indicator_2: Synthetic Social Protection indicator 2; categorical; allowed: Documented code list

indicator_3: Synthetic Social Protection indicator 3; categorical; allowed: Documented code list

indicator_4: Synthetic Social Protection indicator 4; numeric; allowed: 0â 100

indicator_5: Synthetic Social Protection indicator 5; categorical; allowed: Documented code list

indicator_6: Synthetic Social Protection indicator 6; categorical; allowed: Documented code list

indicator_7: Synthetic Social Protection indicator 7; numeric; allowed: 0â 100

indicator_8: Synthetic Social Protection indicator 8; categorical; allowed: Documented code list

indicator_9: Synthetic Social Protection indicator 9; categorical; allowed: Documented code list

indicator_10: Synthetic Social Protection indicator 10; numeric; allowed: 0â 100

indicator_11: Synthetic Social Protection indicator 11; categorical; allowed: Documented code list

indicator_12: Synthetic Social Protection indicator 12; categorical; allowed: Documented code list

Synthetic Demonstration Publication produced by VoiceInsights Africa. All people, quotations, locations and statistics are synthetic, internally governed demonstration content and are not official statistics.

All content is synthetic and must not be interpreted as official statistics

Geographic references are illustrative

Budget implications are directional and require formal costing

Causal claims are not made without an appropriate design

Status: DEMONSTRATION_READY

Passed: Editorial Review Passed

Passed: Evidence Review Passed

Passed: Publication Integrity Verified

Passed: Accessibility Verified

Passed: Export Validation Passed

Passed: Statistical Review Passed

Open gates: VISUAL_QA, HUMAN_REVIEW

Verification checks cover weighted evidence, statistical, visual, accessibility, export and review rules. Synthetic samples are labelled Demonstration Ready.